

# Quiet Exclusion in Open Repositories

## A Documented Case of Automated Restriction and Non-Response

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May 2026

### Abstract

Scientific exclusion is typically understood as explicit rejection. However, exclusion can also occur without any formal decision. This paper presents a documented case of account restriction on Zenodo, followed by prolonged non-response.

The case illustrates a process-level failure in which participation is initially allowed, then interrupted without explanation or recovery pathway. No rejection is issued, yet access is effectively terminated.

This configuration aligns with the concept of quiet exclusion, defined as interaction without progression or completion. The case provides concrete evidence of how automated classification and support non-response can jointly produce exclusion without explicit decision in open scientific systems. Full documentation of the case is provided in Appendix A.

### Process-Level Framework

Scientific access can be described as a sequence of stages: entry, progression, and completion. Participation requires successful transition across all stages.

Exclusion does not require explicit rejection. It can arise when:

- entry is blocked,
- progression is interrupted,
- completion is not reached,
- or access is not restored after disruption.

Quiet exclusion refers to cases where interaction occurs but does not lead to a state transition. The process remains active in form, but inactive in outcome.

### Case Description: Zenodo Account Restriction

An independent researcher uploaded multiple structured research documents to Zenodo over a period of several weeks.

Following this activity:

- the account was automatically flagged for spam,
- all uploaded content was removed,
- the account was blocked,
- no detailed justification was provided.

A request for clarification was submitted on the day of the restriction. A follow-up message was sent several weeks later. No response has been received after approximately 10 weeks.

The uploaded materials included versioned research documents with titles, abstracts, and identifiers. Prior dissemination had occurred, with approximately 4,000 downloads across platforms.

## Observed Mechanism

The restriction was triggered through automated classification. Platform documentation indicates that:

- automated systems may classify content as spam,
- institutional email addresses are used as legitimacy signals,
- misclassification can occur (see Appendix A, Figure 1).

Correction depends on manual review following user contact. In this case, no response was received.

## Conclusion

This case demonstrates that exclusion in open scientific systems does not require explicit rejection. Access may be granted, sustained, and then revoked through automated classification, without explanation or recovery pathway. When correction mechanisms depend on non-responsive channels, false positives may stabilize into persistent exclusion states. This configuration represents a concrete instance of quiet exclusion: interaction without completion.

## Appendix A. Zenodo Account Restriction – Documented Case

### Independent Research Documentation

**Author:** Florian Morin (Independent Researcher) **Date:** May 1, 2026

### Summary

This document presents a structured record of an account restriction on Zenodo. It includes a timeline of events, uploaded materials, correspondence, and a clarification request.

### Context

The uploads are part of an independent research corpus focused on joy mechanisms and evaluative load (Z framework).

### Timeline

- December 2025 – Initial uploads
- January 2026 – Additional uploads
- February 20, 2026 – Account restriction, support contacted
- May 2026 (+10 weeks) – No response received

### Nature of Uploaded Content

Structured research documents including titles, abstracts, references, and versioned entries.

## Dissemination Status

- Prior dissemination confirmed
- Approx. total downloads: ~4000
- Informal academic discussions reported

## Observed Outcome

- Account blocked
- Content removed
- Reason: Spam
- No detailed justification provided

## Potential Misclassification

The upload pattern may resemble automated or bulk submission behavior.

**Figure 1**

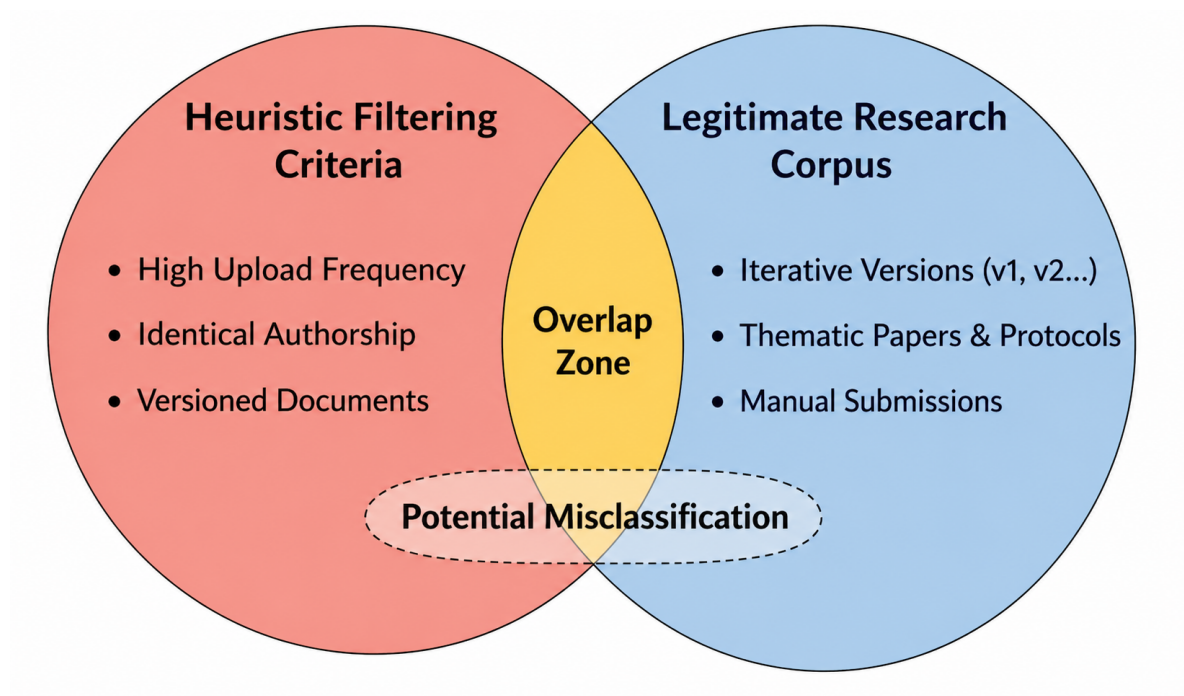


Figure 1: Overlap between automated filtering heuristics and legitimate research workflows.

## Platform Statements

### What if I was wrongly blocked for spam?

If your account has been blocked because of spam, but the content submitted is legitimate research dissemination, then please get in touch with us on our support line, and we'll restore your access and content. We apologise for the inconvenience it may be causing. Unfortunately, both our automated and manual moderation process can make errors, as we're handling very large volumes of submissions on a daily basis.

Figure 2: Zenodo FAQ – spam policy and error handling

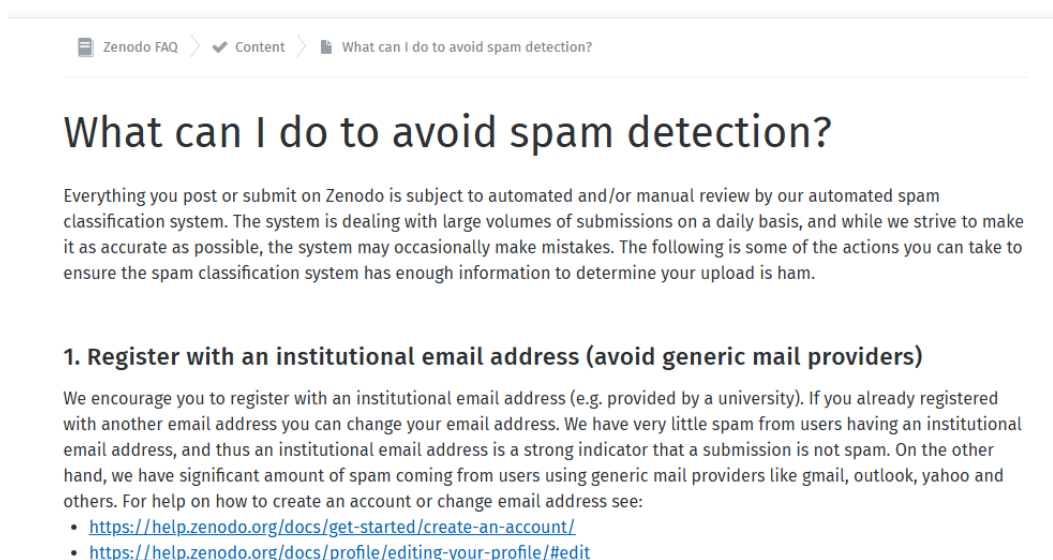


Figure 3: Zenodo FAQ – email and spam detection criteria

These excerpts describe automated moderation rules, classification heuristics, and the possibility of classification errors.

# Correspondence

## Follow-up to Zenodo support – April 1, 2026

### Follow-up on unresolved Zenodo account issue

F

**Florian Morin** <florianmorinind@gmail.com>  
À info

mer. 1 avr. 15:51

☆

😊

Hello,

I am following up on my previous message regarding my Zenodo account.

I still have access to the support channel, but I have not received any response.  
Could you please confirm the status of my account and whether any action is being taken?

For reference:

- account email: [fmorin4@gmail.com](mailto:fmorin4@gmail.com)
- date of first message: 20/02/2026
- issue: Independent researcher without institutional email address, flagged for spam, all documents vanished, thousands of dls, no answer from support. You can read the complete case here: [https://x.com/ease\\_theory/status/2035684832529854756](https://x.com/ease_theory/status/2035684832529854756)

Best Regards,  
Florian.

## External contact (CERN-related) – April 1, 2026

### Request for Clarification Regarding Zenodo Account Status

F

**Florian Morin** <florianmorinind@gmail.com>  
À lars.holm.nielsen

mer. 1 avr. 16:36

☆

Hello,

My Zenodo account appears to have been restricted on February 20, with associated content removal. I contacted support the same day but have not received a response after several weeks.

Could you please clarify the status of the account or indicate whether further information is needed? Additional context (timeline) in pdf.

Best Regards,  
Florian Morin.

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Independent Researcher Documentation

Open Access Publishing

Zenodo Account Restriction - Documented Case

Author: Florian Morin

Version: 1.0 (2026-04-01)

Summary

This document provides a structured record of a Zenodo account restriction.

 Zenodo Account ...

No responses have been received after approximately 10 weeks.

## List of Uploads (Partial Reconstruction)

| Title                                                                         | Date       | Identifier                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Transient Suppression of ACC Monitoring Enables High-Saliency Positive Affect | 24/12/2025 | Record: <a href="https://zenodo.org/records/18048516">https://zenodo.org/records/18048516</a> |
| Affective Collapse Under Causal Closure                                       | Jan 2026   | DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18537408                                                                  |
| Ease: Evaluation kills entry, not the state: a threshold model of ease        | Jan 2026   | DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18224573                                                                  |
| Regime-Preserving Methods for Studying Children's Engagement                  | Jan 2026   | DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18235196                                                                  |
| Ease Open-State Questionnaire (EOSQ, Draft)                                   | Feb 2026   | DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18654831                                                                  |
| Lock-in under suspended optimization                                          | Jan 2026   | Not available                                                                                 |
| Positive Affect Contingent On Suspended Optimization                          | Jan 2026   | Not available                                                                                 |
| Positive Affect as Suspension of Optimization                                 | Jan 2026   | Not available                                                                                 |

*Some entries are referenced via record URLs rather than DOIs due to limited access following account restriction.*

## Prior Dissemination and Informal Discussion

Before the account restriction, parts of the research corpus had already been disseminated and discussed informally with academic researchers.

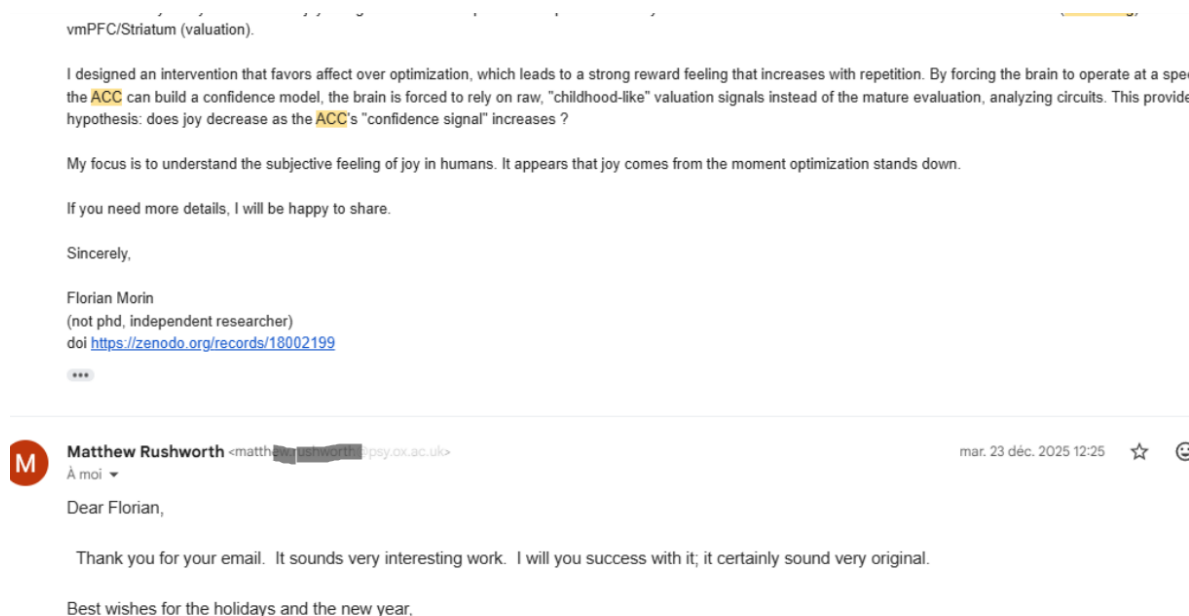


Figure 4: Example of prior informal academic correspondence. This exchange is included to document that the uploaded work had circulated before the account restriction. It should not be interpreted as formal review, endorsement, or validation.

## External Reference

<https://florianmorin.com/papers/regime-of-joy/>

## Notes

This document is a factual record and does not assume intent or error.

The author declares no competing interests.